Configuration is a crucial part of delivering applications. Although it starts with meager requirements that are usually easily met, demands invariably appear that can complicate matters, and often the configuration layer of an application becomes tangled and complex. The Typesafe Config library provides a number of powerful tools to prevent this from happening:

- Easy defaulting based on convention (with overrides)
- Sophisticated defaulting that allows you to require the least amount of configuration necessary
- Several syntax options: traditional, Java, JSON, and HOCON

We haven’t come near to exhausting this topic, but you’ve seen enough to deal with a broad range of typical requirements that will come up as you start to deploy Akka solutions.

Summary

- The Typesafe Config library reads a hierarchy of priorities, including system properties, application.conf, application.json, application.properties, and reference.conf.
- With the HOCON syntax, you can add a default value and an optional value read from the system properties. This way, you can use the default value in one environment—usually local—and override it in other environments, such as stage or production, by setting the system property.